

Reentry Planning & Community Reintegration

Learner guide | SWP-024 | School of Criminal Justice & Forensic Social Work

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Reentry Planning & Community Reintegration. By the end of the course, you should be able to build coordinated plans that support safe reentry after detention or incarceration.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Build coordinated plans that support safe reentry after detention or incarceration.
- Apply the key ideas from Reentry needs.
- Apply the key ideas from Planning before release.
- Apply the key ideas from Community follow-up.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Reentry needs	housing, employment, health, identification, family, stigma, legal obligations, and risk	10 to 15 minutes
2. Planning before release	assessment, goal setting, records transfer, benefits, family preparation, and warm referrals	10 to 15 minutes
3. Community follow-up	continuity of care, peer support, crisis response, progress review, and advocacy	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Reentry needs

This module focuses on housing, employment, health, identification, family, stigma, legal obligations, and risk. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Housing
- Employment
- Health
- Identification
- Family
- Stigma
- Legal obligations
- Risk

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of reentry needs in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of housing, employment, health, identification, family, stigma, legal obligations, and risk. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through reentry needs safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Planning before release

This module focuses on assessment, goal setting, records transfer, benefits, family preparation, and warm referrals. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Assessment
- Goal setting
- Records transfer
- Benefits
- Family preparation
- Warm referrals

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of planning before release in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of assessment, goal setting, records transfer, benefits, family preparation, and warm referrals. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through planning before release safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Community follow-up

This module focuses on continuity of care, peer support, crisis response, progress review, and advocacy. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Continuity of care
- Peer support
- Crisis response
- Progress review
- Advocacy

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of community follow-up in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of continuity of care, peer support, crisis response, progress review, and advocacy. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through community follow-up safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: needs assessment.
- Review the distinction between: pre-release planning.
- Review the distinction between: continuity of care.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.